

CUT THE REGULATORY FLAB

► India's complex regulatory system burdens employers with redundant compliance requirements. Despite efforts to simplify laws, outdated manual processes persist. A digital, risk-based, transparent, and faceless system is necessary for licensing, inspections, filings, and renewals. Data from a TeamLease Regtech and ORF report shows that firms have to comply with 1,536 Acts and rules, 69,233 compliances and 6,618 filings. Among the Acts and rules, 843 account for 26,134 compliances. Deregulation is critical.

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A BUREAUCRACY FOR THE 21ST CENTURY

► India's bureaucracy, the iron framework that runs the country and implements policies, needs a makeover to bring it in sync with the evolving economic and social dynamics. Moving from a *mai-baap* role to a more egalitarian outlook is a key ask. A clear policy on lateral hiring would enable the entry of specialists from the private sector. An independent civil services board should be set up to curb political interference in postings, transfers and disciplinary action.



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JUDICIAL REFORMS TO AVOID TAREEK PE TAREEK

► With court cases often dragging on for years—it can take anywhere from one to 20 years to resolve disputes—judicial reforms are a pressing need. More benches and judges, faster filling up of vacancies, online hearings and technology adoption are crucial. Tax disputes need to be resolved faster, too. For foreign investors, contract enforcement remains a big worry. This reform will improve sentiment. After all, justice delayed is justice denied!

